CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

ONLINE TUTOR IN THE AI ERA

Your competition gives the same product away free — and the platform still takes a third of your price.

★ TL;DR — NO. BLS itself says generative AI 'will somewhat reduce the need for tutors,' in an occupation already flat at 0% growth with a ~$43K median — and a beginner on the platforms nets $10–20 an hour after tolls and unpaid trial lessons. The roadmap below moves the same skill to where it's still sold: in person, premium, direct. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

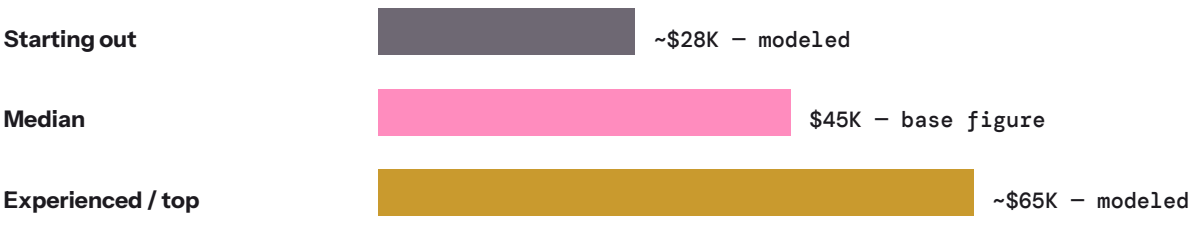
OUR TAKE: NO — NOT IN 2027

MEDIAN ~$45K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK MEDIUM

- The product is the problem: generic homework help is exactly what ChatGPT and Khanmigo now give away — Chegg's subscribers fell 31% year over year after free AI ate its product.
- The platform math is brutal at entry: Preply keeps 100% of every trial lesson and 33% of a new tutor's rate; Wyzant keeps 25%. A $20 list price nets a beginner $13.40.
- The hours ceiling is structural — demand is after-school peaks and test-season spikes, mostly part-time by design, and all ~34,200 yearly openings are replacements.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Online Tutor is a ~$45K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A ONLINE TUTOR ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Run one-to-one or small-group sessions over video
- ✓ Diagnose what the student actually doesn't understand (it's rarely the stated topic)
- ✓ Build practice plans between sessions and track progress
- ✓ Report to parents or the student in plain, honest terms

Think: a personal trainer for one subject — the plan matters less than showing up, adjusting, and keeping them going.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Explanations, worked solutions, practice sets and instant feedback — the core of online tutoring — are now generated free by ChatGPT and Khanmigo (700,000+ district users in 2024–25). BLS names generative AI as reducing the need for tutors.	Supervision, accountability and trust: a booked adult who makes the student show up and do the work. That layer is only sellable in the room — which is why the exit door is in person.

⚠ **DON'T CITE THE COLLAPSE WRONG: BYJU'S fell to debt and governance failure, not AI — the honest evidence is bad enough without it. Chegg is the real exhibit: the moment a free chatbot matched its product, subscribers fell 31% in a year. Generic online homework help is that product.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ The same teaching skill, sold where humans are the point ✓ 100% of your rate on direct bookings ✓ Evenings that end — a local roster, not a global queue	✗ Travel between students eats billable hours ✗ You are still the marketing department ✗ Peak hours are still evenings, weekends and test season

Good fit? You explain things patiently three different ways, and you genuinely like the subject you'd teach.
Bad fit? You want passive income or dislike being 'on' with people for hours.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — PIVOT TO PRIVATE TUTOR (IN PERSON)	DOOR B — PIVOT TO SCHOOL TEACHER

Same occupation on paper ($43,350 median), completely different economics: booked directly and locally, you keep 100% of the rate instead of 67–75% of it. Aim at the segment AI substitutes least — test prep and premium families: posted test-prep rates average ~$100/hr (Care.com), and BLS itself projects private-tutoring demand to continue as applicants compete to stand out. First move: pick one exam you can score at the top of, and sell it within driving distance.	If you want tutoring to become a salary, the licensed classroom is the version with one: medians of $63,820–$72,040 by level, ~201,700 openings a year, and a licence AI cannot legally substitute. Your tutoring hours are your audition tape — districts hire people who have already held students' attention. First move: map your state's licence — the bachelor's route, or alternative certification if you already hold a degree.

Smart move: Use platforms the way they use you: take their students once for the leads, then move the relationship direct. On Wyzant, students you referred yourself are already yours at 100% — build every booking with that exit in mind.
Where you land after: A local, premium tutoring practice that keeps its whole rate — or a licensed classroom with a salary, if you take Door B.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
LEAVE THE	REBUILD THE	GET THE	PROVE RESULTS	SYSTEMISE THE	RAISE AND

STEP 1 — Leave the queue

FREE · TODAY

- Do the platform maths on your own rate: list price minus 25–33%, minus unpaid trials and prep
- Decide your segment: test prep or premium local families — the two buyers who pay for a human

STEP 2 — Rebuild the offer in person

FREE · WEEK 1

- Pick one exam or subject with proof you can show — your own top score is the credential here
- Set a direct-booking rate: elementary posted floors start ~$24/hr, test prep ~$100/hr

STEP 3 — Get the first local students

WEEKS 2-6

- Parent groups, school-adjacent networks, referrals from your current online students
- Offer a paid diagnostic session, not a free trial — free trials are the platform trap

STEP 4 — Prove results

MONTHS 2-3

- Track score gains and grades; collect parent testimonials with numbers
- Move platform students to direct booking wherever the terms allow

STEP 5 — Systemise the roster MONTHS 3-5

- Fixed weekly slots, a cancellation policy, pre-test intensive packages
- Cap the travel radius — drive time is your new platform fee if you let it grow

STEP 6 — Raise and specialise MONTHS 5-6

- Raise rates on proof; a waitlist beats discounting
- Decide the bigger swing: a premium practice, or the teaching licence for a salary (Door B)

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

□ Today: your real hourly number, after tolls and unpaid trials, written down. Compare it with the ~$24/hr posted local floors.

□ Days 1–30: segment chosen, direct rate set, first local inquiries from parent networks.

□ Days 31–60: first in-person students booked directly; score-tracking in place.

□ Days 61–90: testimonials with numbers in hand; platform hours cut to lead generation only.

□ Day 90: you're a local tutor keeping your whole rate — not a profile in a queue competing with free.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **ANSWERS ARE FREE NOW.** ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.